RWANDA RENTALS

Product Features & Platform Requirements

Feature backlog — Ashley's proposals + Lorenzo's additional product features

1. Colorful but Clean UI

Create a colorful, modern interface that reflects Rwanda Rentals without becoming visually busy. The design should feel trustworthy, simple, youthful, and easy to navigate.

2. In-App Chat & AI Housing Assistant

Allow renters and landlords to communicate directly inside Rwanda Rentals instead of immediately exchanging phone numbers. Include moderation/reporting tools. Add an AI housing assistant that can understand requests such as "I'm looking for a 2-bedroom apartment in Kicukiro under 400,000 RWF" and help users find matching listings faster.

3. Property Verification

Introduce verification checks so renters can have greater confidence that a listed property exists and accurately represents the photos and description. Verified listings should receive a clear verification badge.

4. Photos + Video Listings

Allow landlords and property managers to upload both photos and videos. Video tours should help renters understand the property before arranging a physical viewing.

5. Things to Do / Nearby Places

Show useful information about what is around each property, such as restaurants, schools, shopping, gyms, hospitals, entertainment, public transport, and attractions. The goal is to help users understand the lifestyle and convenience of the location.

6. Smart Search & Advanced Filters

Provide detailed filters for location, price, bedrooms, bathrooms, property type, furnished/unfurnished status, rental duration, amenities, verification status, student-friendly properties, and other relevant requirements.

7. Map-Based Property Discovery

Let users browse listings on an interactive map as well as in a traditional list. Users should be able to understand where a property is relative to universities, workplaces, transport, shopping, and other important locations.

8. Saved Properties / Favourites

Allow users to save properties they are interested in and create a personal shortlist for easier decision-making.

9. Smart Property Alerts

Users should be able to create search alerts based on their requirements. For example: “Notify me whenever a 2-bedroom apartment under 400,000 RWF becomes available in Kicukiro.”

10. Viewing Requests & Scheduling

Allow renters to request property viewings through the platform, select preferred dates and times, and receive confirmation or alternative times from landlords. This can later support virtual viewing options..

11. Clear Listing Status

Every property should clearly show whether it is Available, Viewing Scheduled, Rented, or Temporarily Unavailable. This helps reduce inquiries about properties that are no longer available.

12. Landlord Profiles

Create landlord/property-manager profiles showing relevant information such as verification status, number of listings, response rate, and response time.

13. Reviews & Ratings

Allow renters to review properties and/or landlords after legitimate interactions such as renting or completing a verified viewing. Include safeguards against fake, abusive, or competitor-generated reviews.

14. Digital Rental Application

Allow renters to submit basic rental applications through Rwanda Rentals instead of moving immediately to external messaging platforms. Landlords can review applications from their dashboard.

15. Report Listing

Allow users to report fake properties, scams, misleading photos or information, incorrect prices, duplicate listings, and inappropriate content. Reports should feed into an administrative review system.

16. AI-Powered Property Matching

Use AI to match renters with properties based on their requirements and lifestyle. For example, a student could specify budget, school area, transport needs, preferred environment, and other priorities, and Rwanda Rentals can rank listings by overall suitability.